EMOTION





Emotion is a multifaceted psychological and physiological response to stimuli, involving subjective experiences, physiological changes, and behavioral expressions.



Subjective Experience: The internal, personal feeling an individual has, such as happiness, fear, or sadness (Ekman, 1992).

Physiological Responses: Bodily reactions triggered by emotions, like increased heart rate or changes in facial expression (Damasio, 1999).

Behavioral Expression: Observable actions or facial expressions that convey the emotion, like smiling when happy or unhappy when angry (Ekman, 2003).

Example

- Suppose you're stuck in traffic, and you're running late for an important meeting.
- The frustration builds, and you feel your anger rising.



Subjectively

You might clench your fists

Physiologically

Your body releases stress hormones like cortisol, and you may experience an increased heart rate.

Behaviorally

This anger can motivate you to drive more aggressively or express your frustration verbally.

It helps you focus on the cause of your stress and sometimes prompts you to take action, like trying to find an alternate route.

- According to the American Psychological Association (APA), emotion is defined as a complex state of feeling that results in physical and psychological changes that influence thought and behavior" (APA, 2020).

- Emotions can range from positive feelings such as happiness and love to negative ones like anger and fear

- They are integral to decision-making, motivation, social interaction, and survival.



Expression and Perception of Emotion



- Emotions are fundamental components of human experience that influence behavior, cognition, and social interactions.
- The expression and perception of emotions are crucial in how people understand themselves and others.
- These processes are interconnected but distinct, and involve a complex interplay of physiological, cognitive, and cultural factors.

Expression of Emotion

- Emotional expression refers to the outward display of an individual's internal emotional state.
- These expressions can be manifested through facial expressions, body language, tone of voice, and physiological changes such as heart rate and skin conductance.



1. Facial Expressions of Emotion



- One of the most studied forms of emotional expression is facial expressions.
- Research by Paul Ekman (1971) established that there are universally recognized facial expressions for basic emotions such as happiness, sadness, anger, fear, surprise, and disgust.
- For example, a smile typically signals happiness, while furrowing one's brows may indicate anger or confusion.
- These expressions are generally automatic and occur without conscious effort.

2. Body Language and Gestures



In addition to facial expressions, body language plays an important role in emotional expression.



Cross-cultural studies by Ekman and Friesen (1975) have shown that postures, gestures, and movements can also convey emotions.
For instance, a person slumping their shoulders and avoiding eye contact may express sadness or dejection.



Gestures such as clenching fists can signify anger or frustration, while fidgeting may indicate nervousness.

3. Vocal Cues

- Voice is another significant medium of emotional expression. The tone, pitch, and rate of speech can all convey emotional states.

- For instance, a high-pitched voice or an elevated rate of speech may be associated with excitement or nervousness, whereas a slow, monotone voice may indicate sadness or boredom.

- Research by Juslin and Laukka (2001) found that vocal expressions can reliably convey emotions, with listeners being able to identify emotions such as happiness, sadness, and anger based on tone alone.



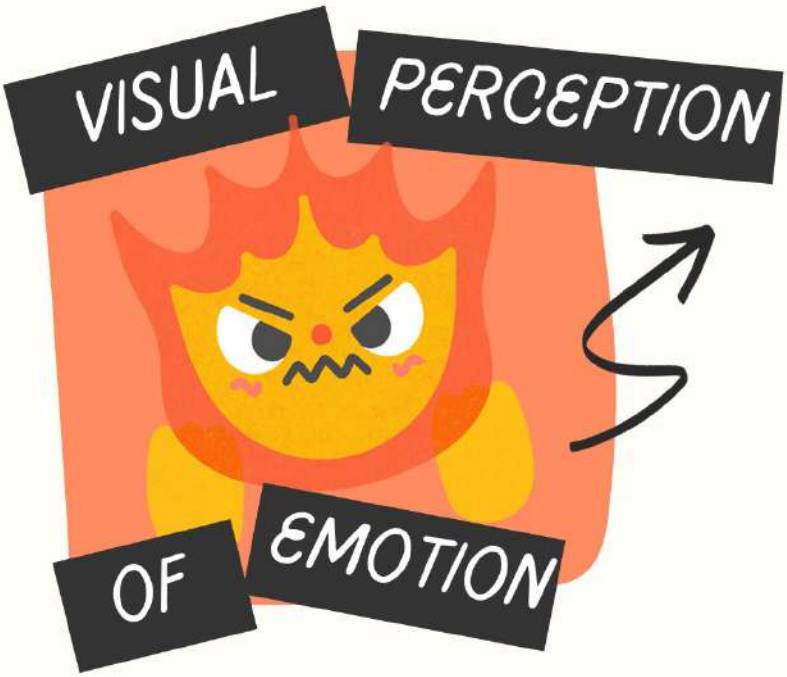


PERCEPTION OF EMOTION!



Emotional perception refers to the ability to identify and interpret emotions in others.

This ability is vital for social communication, helping individuals respond appropriately to social cues.



- Facial expressions are one of the primary cues for perceiving emotion in others.
- Ekman's (1992) work on the facial feedback hypothesis suggests that not only do we use facial expressions to convey our emotions, but perceiving facial expressions can also influence our own emotional state.
- For instance, seeing someone smile might make an observer feel happier, a phenomenon often referred to as emotional contagion.

AUDITORY PERCEPTION OF EMOTION

Auditory cues are also crucial in perceiving emotions.



The tone of a person's voice can reveal a range of emotions, such as joy, frustration, or sadness.



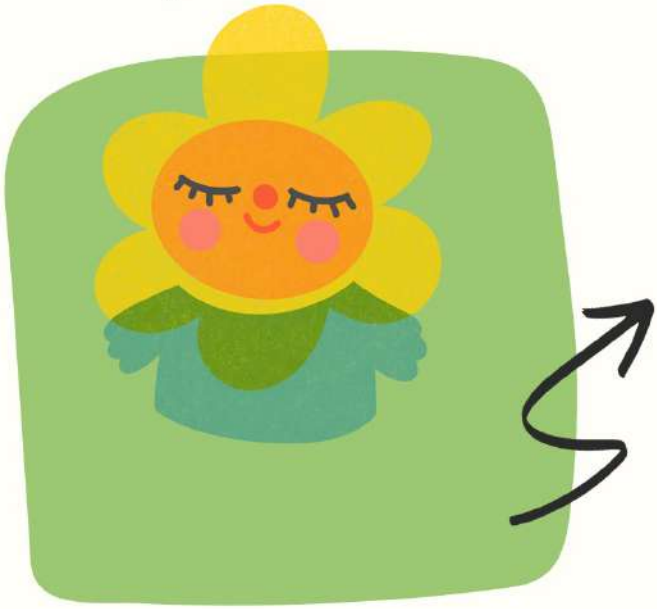
A study by Scherer (2003) found that specific vocal attributes such as the pitch, speed, and intensity of speech are strongly linked to perception of emotional states.



For instance, a trembling voice might be associated with perception fear or anxiety, while a loud, harsh tone could signal to perceive anger or frustration.

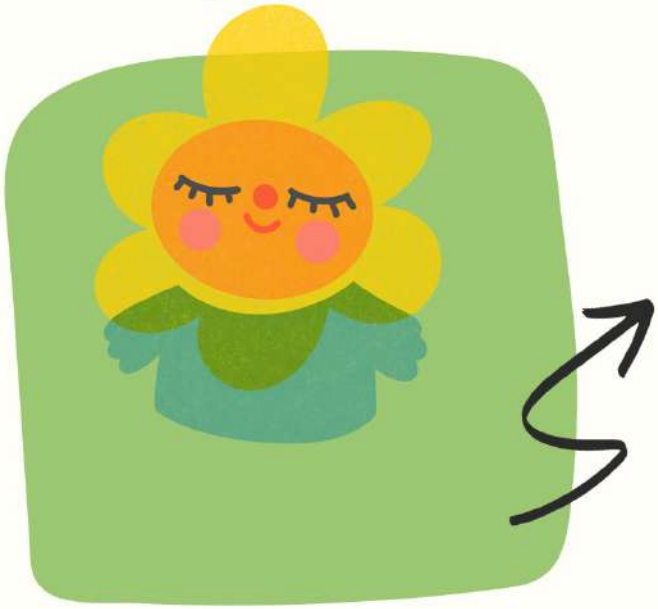


Interplay between Emotion Expression and Perception



- The expression and perception of emotions are mutually influential.
- Emotional expressions not only communicate feelings to others but also serve as a feedback mechanism for the person expressing the emotion.
- When people express emotions, they often look for feedback from others to gauge how their emotion is being understood.
- This feedback, in turn, can modify their emotional experience or expression.

Interplay between Emotion Expression and Perception



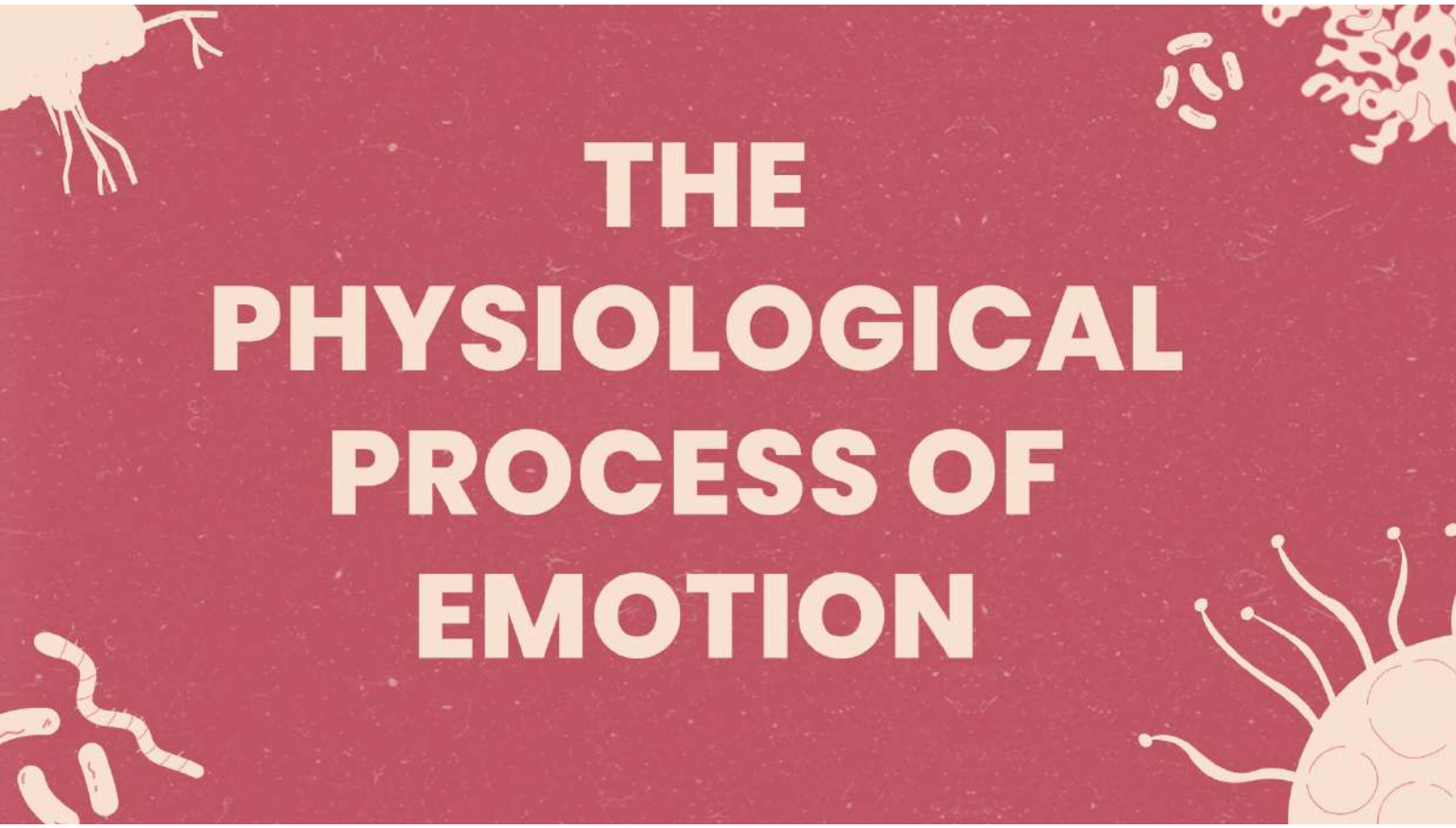
Example

A child who expresses sadness might look to their caregiver for comfort.

If the caregiver responds with empathy and understanding, the child's emotional state may be lightened.

Conversely, if the caregiver responds harshly, the child's emotional state may worsen.

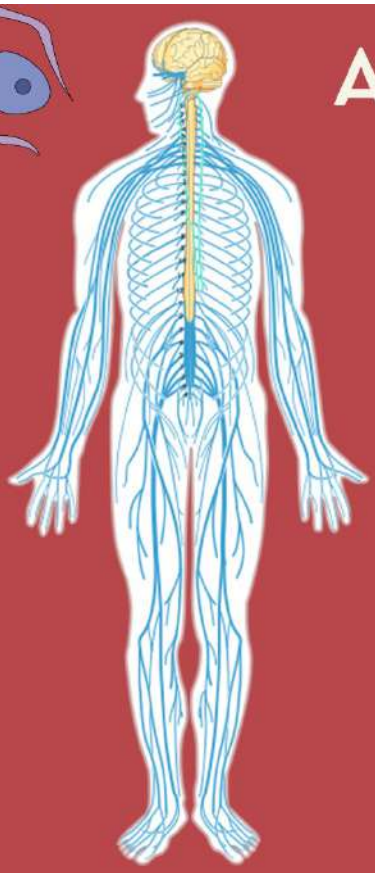
This process highlights the dynamic relationship between emotional expression and perception.


THE
PHYSIOLOGICAL
PROCESS OF
EMOTION

Introduction

- The physiology of emotion refers to the physical changes that occur in our bodies when we experience different emotions.
- These changes are mainly driven by the autonomic nervous system, the brain, and hormonal responses, all of which help our bodies respond to and process emotional stimuli.





AUTONOMIC NERVOUS SYSTEM

The automatic nervous system, which includes the sympathetic and parasympathetic nervous systems, plays a crucial role in the physiological responses to emotion.

- **Sympathetic Nervous System:** Activates the body's fight or flight response when faced with stress or danger. It increases heart rate, dilates pupils, and redirects blood flow from internal organs to muscles.
- **Parasympathetic Nervous System:** Calms the body down after stress, lowering heart rate and helping the body return to a relaxed state.

Example, for fear Response when you encounter a threat, such as seeing a snake, your sympathetic nervous system is activated. Your heart rate increases, your breathing becomes faster, and your pupils dilate preparing you to either fight or escape (Cannon, 1939).

BRAIN ACTIVITY

The brain plays a central role in recognizing and processing emotions. Different parts of the brain are involved in different aspects of emotional experience

AMYGDALA

This part of the brain is crucial for processing emotional stimuli, especially fear. It signals the body to react to threats.

PREFRONTAL CORTEX

This area is involved in regulating emotional responses based on cognitive processing, such as interpreting the cause of an emotion.



EXAMPLE

for seeing a threat when you see something threatening, such as a snake, the amygdala triggers an emotional response (fear).

It sends signals to the hypothalamus to activate the sympathetic nervous system, and the prefrontal cortex may help you decide on a course of action (e.g., flee or freeze).

HORMONAL RESPONSES

Hormones released during emotional experiences help prepare the body to respond.

ADRENALINE (EPINEPHRINE)

Released during stressful situations, it boosts energy and alertness by increasing heart rate and redirecting blood flow to muscles.

CORTISOL

Known as the stress hormone, it helps the body respond to stress by increasing glucose levels in the blood.

OXYTOCIN

Often called the "love hormone," it promotes social bonding and feelings of happiness.



OVERVIEW

Conclusion 01

Emotions begin in the brain, where different regions (like the amygdala for fear, and the prefrontal cortex for sadness) process the emotional stimuli.

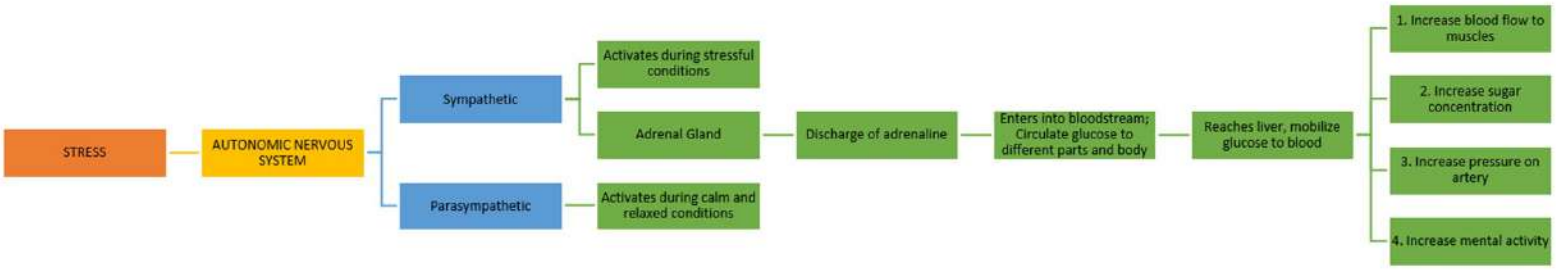
Conclusion 02

These emotional responses activate the nervous system (like the sympathetic or parasympathetic systems), leading to the release of hormones like adrenaline, dopamine, or cortisol.

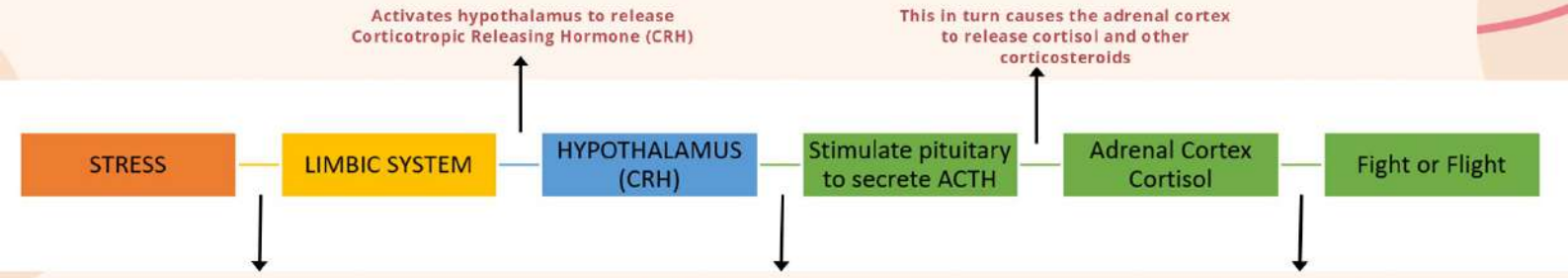
Conclusion 03

These changes cause physical reactions in the body, such as increased heart rate, muscle tension, or changes in breathing.

Cannon (1932) described physiology of stress response



The second physiological response is through the Pituitary Gland

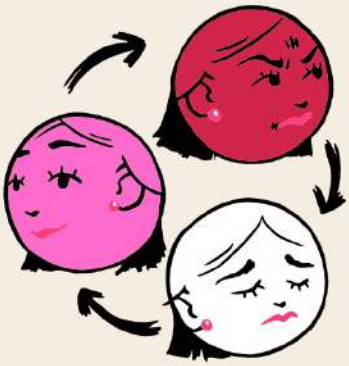


Increased activity of limbic system

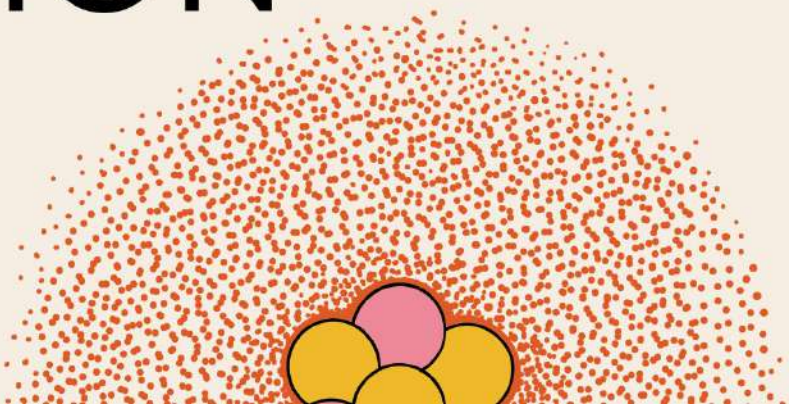
CRH stimulates pituitary gland to secrete adrenocorticotropic hormone (ACTH)

- It facilitates metabolic function for fight or flight reaction that releases stress
- It also sends feedback to hypothalamus and pituitary gland to produce excessive cortisol
- Prolonged release may affect health

THEORY OF EMOTION







THEORIES



1. James-Lange Theory
2. Cannon-Bard Theory
3. Schachter-Singer Theory
4. Facial Feedback Theory
5. Lazarus' Cognitive-Mediational Theory

JAMES-LANGE THEORY



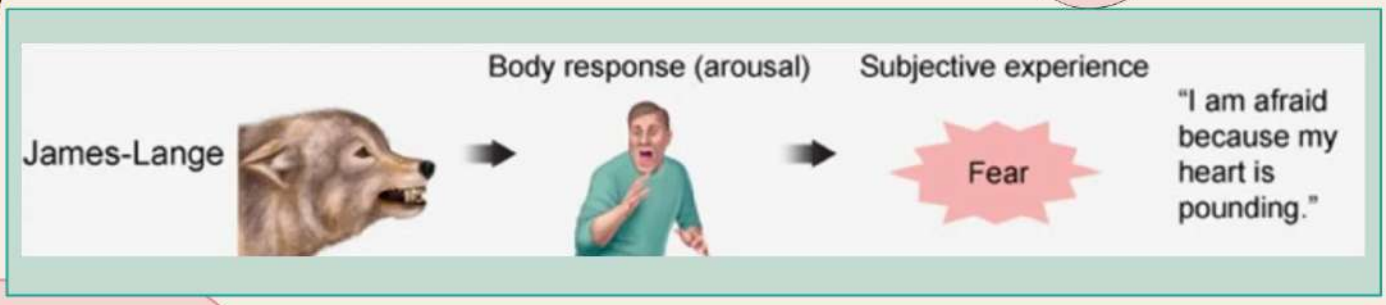
The James-Lange Theory posits that emotions are the result of physiological reactions to events.



In other words, you feel emotions because your body reacts in certain ways, like heart rate increasing or muscles tensing.



The theory suggests that your body reacts first, and then you interpret these physical changes as specific emotions.



EXAMPLE

- According to the James-Lange Theory, the body's physical reactions (increased heart rate, sweating) come first, and then you interpret these physiological changes as fear.
- You feel fear because your body is reacting fearfully.





CANNON-BARD THEORY

- The Cannon-Bard Theory suggests that emotions and physiological responses happen simultaneously, not one after the other.

- When an emotional event occurs, the brain processes the emotion and sends signals to the body to produce a physiological reaction at the same time.

- This theory challenges the James-Lange Theory, which says physical reactions come before emotions.

EXAMPLE

Cannon-Bard



Body response (arousal)



Subjective experience

Fear

"My heart is pounding and the wolf makes me feel afraid."

- According to Cannon Bard, the feeling of nervousness and the increase in heart rate happen simultaneously.
- Your brain processes the emotion of nervousness and sends signals to your body to react, so both things occur together.





SCHACHTER-SINGER THEORY (TWO-FACTOR THEORY)

- It asserts that emotion is based on two factors, physiological arousal and cognitive interpretation.

- When we experience a physiological change (like a racing heart), we then look at the situation to determine what emotion we're feeling.
- So, arousal is interpreted in context, and this shapes the emotion we feel.

- suppose you're in a situation where you're suddenly startled by a loud noise. Your heart rate increases and you feel tense.
- If you’re in a safe environment, you might interpret this as surprise or excitement.
- However, if you're in a dark alley and the noise is loud and unexpected, your body’s arousal might be interpreted as fear.

EXAMPLE

- The context of the situation plays a big role in determining the emotion you feel.



FACIAL FEEDBACK THEORY



The Facial Feedback Theory suggests that facial expressions can influence our emotions.

This theory proposes that when we make certain facial expressions (like smiling or angry), it sends feedback to the brain that can intensify or even create an emotional experience.

In other words, you might feel happy if you force yourself to smile, or you might feel sad if you frown.

FACIAL FEEDBACK THEORY



- For example, Imagine you're feeling a bit down, but you decide to force yourself to smile.
- According to the Facial Feedback Theory, the act of smiling will send signals to your brain, which might make you feel a bit happier or more positive.
- The physical act of smiling feeds back into your emotional state, improving it.



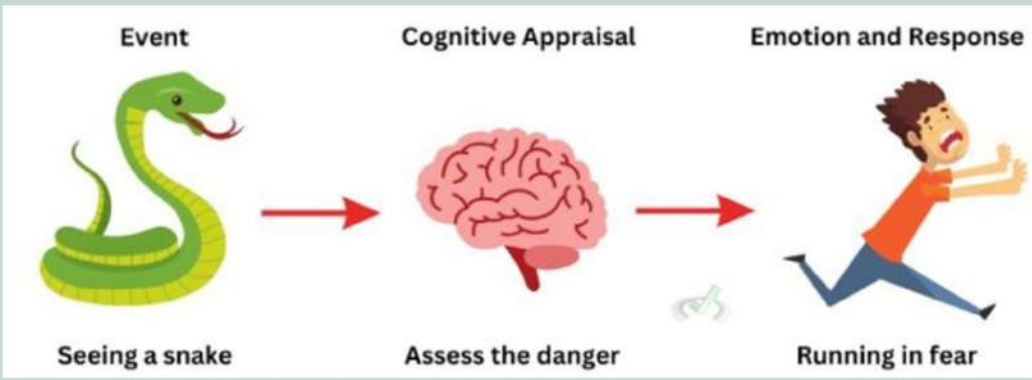
LAZARUS' COGNITIVE-MEDIATIONAL THEORY

- Lazarus' Cognitive Mediational Theory argues that our emotional experience is influenced by how we appraise or interpret an event.

- In this theory, the cognitive appraisal (evaluation of the event) happens first, and then it leads to both emotional and physiological reactions.

- The theory focuses on the importance of our interpretation or perception of an event in shaping the emotional outcome.

EXAMPLE



- According to Cannon Bard, the feeling of nervousness and the increase in heart rate happen simultaneously.
- Your brain processes the emotion of nervousness and sends signals to your body to react, so both things occur together.





James-Lange Theory

Arousal (snake) → Heart pounding, sweating → Fear (emotion)

Cannon-Bard Theory

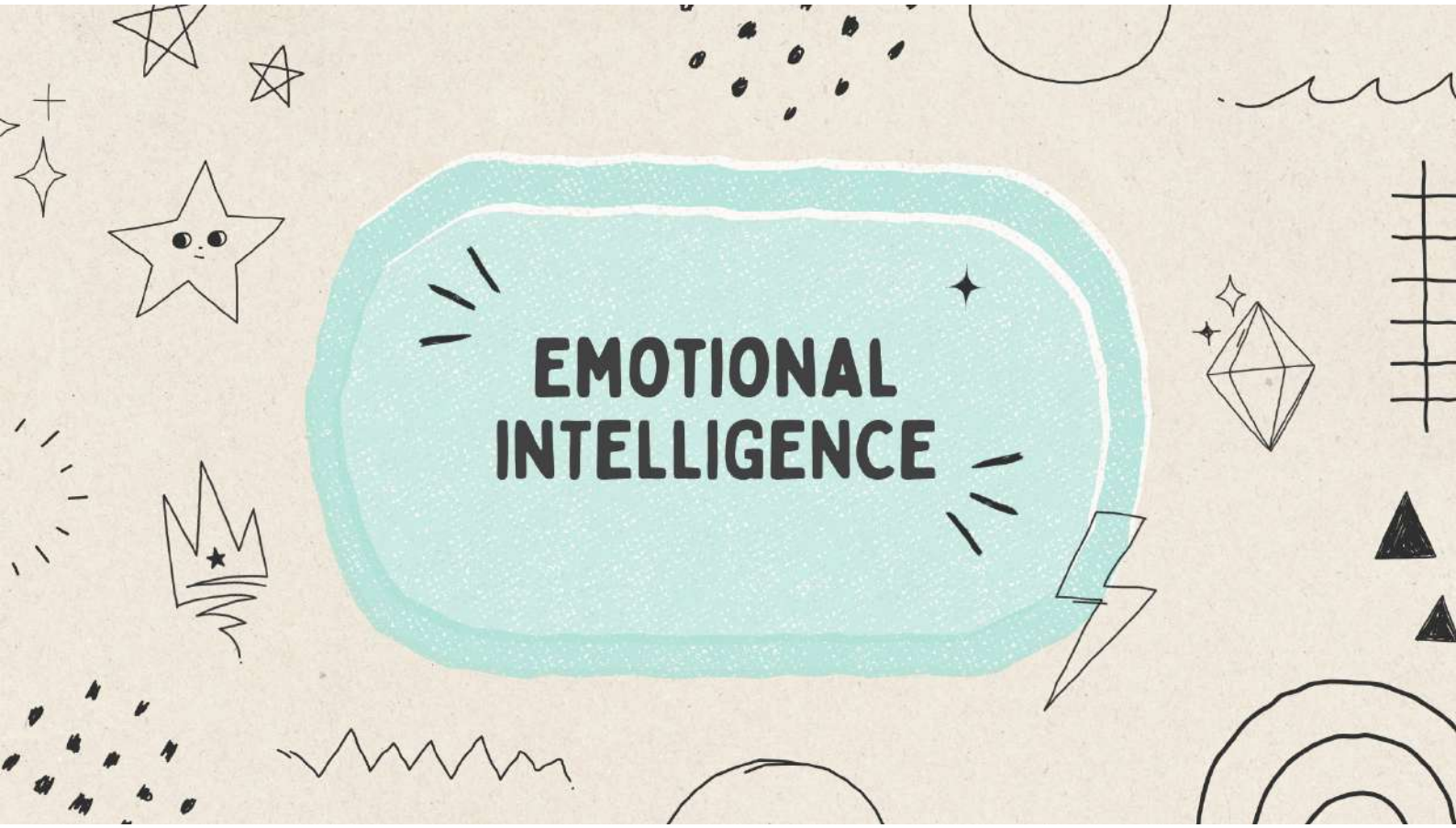
Arousal (snake) → Heart pounding, sweating
Arousal (snake) → Fear (emotion)

Schachter-Singer Two-Factor Theory

Arousal (snake) → Heart pounding, sweating → Fear (emotion)
Arousal (snake) → Cognitive label ("I'm scared") → Fear (emotion)

Lazarus' Cognitive-mediational Theory

Arousal (snake) → Appraisal → Fear/Heart pounding, sweating


EMOTIONAL
INTELLIGENCE

Emotional Intelligence, often referred to as Emotional Quotient, is the ability to recognize, understand, manage, and influence emotions in ourselves and others.

Components of Emotional Intelligence: Psychologist Daniel Goleman is often recognised with popularizing the concept of emotional intelligence.

He identified five key components of emotional intelligence:

- Self-awareness
- Self-regulation
- Motivation
- Empathy
- Social skilla

SELF-AWARENESS

Self-awareness is the ability to recognize and understand your own emotions. People with high self-awareness are in tune with how they feel and why they feel that way, which helps them make better decisions.

For example, imagine you're in a meeting at work and feel irritated when a colleague interrupts you. A person with high self-awareness would pause, recognize their frustration, and realize it's not about the colleague but more about the pressure they've been feeling lately.

This understanding prevents them from reacting impulsively and helps them manage their emotions more calmly.

SELF-REGULATION

Self-regulation involves controlling your emotions, particularly in situations where you may feel overwhelmed or upset. It's about staying calm and composed even in difficult circumstances.

For example, during a stressful family event, you find yourself arguing with a sibling. Instead of shouting or saying something hurtful in the heat of the moment, someone with high emotional intelligence can step back, breathe, and take a moment to collect their thoughts.

By doing so, they can respond in a more measured and constructive way, ultimately avoiding further conflict.

MOTIVATION



Motivation in emotional intelligence refers to being driven by internal goals and values, rather than external rewards or recognition. It involves having the passion and determination to pursue long-term objectives.

For example, an employee at work may be dealing with a monotonous task but continues to push through because they are motivated by the larger goal contributing to a project that will help the company grow. Even without immediate rewards, their intrinsic motivation keeps them focused and productive.

Empathy

Empathy is the ability to understand and share the feelings of others.

Empathy is the ability to understand and share the feelings of others.

For example, Imagine a friend is going through a tough time after losing a loved one. A person with high empathy will listen without judgment, offer comfort, and help the person feel understood.

They might say, "I can't imagine how hard this must be for you, but I'm here to support you." This shows empathy and helps the other person feel cared for.

Social Skills



Social skills are crucial for managing relationships effectively, including communication, collaboration, and conflict resolution.



For example, in a work setting, a manager with strong social skills can mediate a conflict between two team members.



People with strong social skills can connect with others, build trust, and handle social situations with ease.



Rather than taking sides, they listen to both perspectives, encourage open communication, and help the team find a resolution. Their ability to foster cooperation and trust improves the work environment and team morale.